COUNTRY REPORTS: CHAD

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Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Tchad Connexion 2030, published in 2025, is a US$1.5 billion plan to digitise and interconnect all public services, sitting alongside the Plan Stratégique de Développement du Numérique et des Postes 2020-2030, and Chad has no institution to run it: no dedicated digital government institution exists, no machinery coordinates or audits government technology across ministries, and nothing about that function is transparent to the public (2025). The standing sector instrument remains the Strategic Plan 2020-2030 for the postal, electronic communication and digital economy sector, published by the communications ministry, which carries broadband, universal access, digital identification, digital payments and e-commerce.

Newer commitments arrive through the budget rather than through strategy. The "zéro cash, zéro papier" mandate sits under the Public Finance Reform Strategy 2022-2027, justified by revenue security, spending control and traceability, and the 2027 orientations restate it with a new start date, with no cost, no phasing and no named implementing agency (August 2026). The national biometric registry is presented by the authorities as an instrument of Tchad Connexion 2030 (March 2026), and the government frames digital regulation as sovereignty, its then-minister for digital economy stating in December 2025 that "in the digital age, a country that does not control its data does not control its destiny".

The administration these plans have to work through is thin and getting thinner. Chad scores 34.8 out of 100 for overall governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance, 47th of 54 African states and 14.5 points below the African average (2023), scoring above that average on only 15 of the index's 96 indicators. Within its best-scoring economic sub-category, Effective Administration — the professionalism and reach of the bureaucracy — fell 3.5 points to 30.8, 47th of 54. The ministry and the United Nations regional commission validated the national data governance strategy at a workshop in N'Djamena, on seven pillars (2026).

Legislation and regulation

Chad's parliament completed ratification in December 2025 of a change to its telecommunications statute that runs to exactly one article. Ordonnance n°011/PR/2025 of 5 August 2025 amends article 18 of the 2014 law on the regulation of electronic communications and postal activities, and was ratified by the National Assembly on 22 October 2025 by 105 votes to 31 with 2 abstentions; the Senate followed on 23 December 2025 by 65 votes of 67, ratifying the ordinance's amendment of article 18 of Loi n°013/PR/2014. The article it reaches is the statute's enforcement machinery: it lets the regulator ARCEP serve an operator with a mise en demeure of up to 30 days for breach of national law or of the conditions of its authorisation, or for anticompetitive conduct.

The rest of the framework is a decade old. Law No. 009/PR/2015 on cybersecurity and the fight against cybercrime is the single text carrying the legal basis for cybersecurity, data protection, digital identification, digital payments, digital signatures and e-commerce, alongside Law No. 014/PR/2014, which covers broadband, quality of service, digital identification and digital payments. The 2015 package of five laws gives a broad digital-economy base but establishes no authority for cross-government data sharing and governs no data exchange system. There is no right to information law, and neither supporting access-to-records measure is in place (2025).

Of thirty instruments surveyed across identity, cybersecurity, fintech, e-government, artificial intelligence and connectivity, twenty-one have no Chadian counterpart — among them a digital identity law, an interoperability framework, a national cybersecurity strategy, critical-infrastructure protection, cloud and open data policy, an AI strategy, a startup act, a regulatory sandbox and spectrum policy.

The government's own position is that this will not hold: a 34-member committee with a 45-day deadline was inaugurated on 27 April 2026 to overhaul the digital, telecom and postal legal framework, which it considers outdated relative to the pace of innovation. Where law reaches citizens it is doing repair work: a moratorium signed on 2 February 2026 suspends greffe fees on jugements supplétifs, the court order substituting for a missing birth record, until 2030 — needed under a framework that already makes birth registration universal, free and mandatory. A draft labour code adopted by the Council of Ministers on 3 September 2026 would bring digital platform workers under labour law with a presumption of salaried status.

Data protection

Chad's newest data law regulates the state's use of biometrics rather than citizens' exposure to it. The National Assembly adopted on 10 April 2026, by 138 votes to 1, a law governing the collection, processing, retention, use and destruction of biometric data exclusively within judicial and judicial-police procedures — a text about police and prosecutors rather than a general protection for personal data.

The general regime is Act No. 007/PR/2015 of 10 February 2015, implemented by Decree No. 075/PR/2019, which governs the collection, processing, storage and transmission of personal data, including the biometric and identity data processed under the national ID system. It sits with ANSICE, created under Act No. 006/PR/2015 and operational since 2020, with powers to investigate complaints, authorise cross-border transfers and sanction violations — a body whose mandate the Senate ratified an ordinance to widen on 13 March 2026, from cybersecurity to personal-data protection, electronic-transaction security, cybercrime, protection of the national information space and the regulation of video-surveillance and drones. The World Bank's assessment is that the framework in place is not yet fully applied, the government not yet able to manage security breaches in key public systems or to provide digital trust services including authentication and certification (2023).

Two gaps are structural. No statutory duty obliges any data controller to notify users, regulators or the authority of a breach or unauthorised access, though breaches of the Act carry one to five years' imprisonment and fines of XAF 1-10 million, and the general consumer protection law, No. 005/PR/2015, carries no payment-specific rules on error resolution, chargebacks or e-money disputes. Meanwhile identification duties keep widening: SIM registration against a national ID card or passport is compulsory, operators must maintain customer identification databases and give the government access to them, and an arrêté of August 2025 requires every Starlink user — individual, company or public institution — to be formally identified with ARCEP or a licensed operator, supplying identity, address, legal references and the serial numbers of modems, routers and antennas.

Regional collaboration

The rules governing Chad's mobile money are written mostly regionally. Payment institutions are licensed and supervised under the CEMAC framework regulation of 21 December 2018, which replaced 2011 rules confining mobile operators to issuing electronic money, and a licence under it carries bank-grade obligations: FCFA 500 million of fully paid-up capital, reinforced solvency norms, periodic cybersecurity audits, AML/CFT processes and absolute ring-fencing of client balances, in exchange for deposits, withdrawals, account-to-account transfers, cross-border remittances and merchant payments. The one national rule sits in fiscal law: the 2024 finance law gives every SIM holder identified by national identification number the right to an automatically created mobile-money account from 1 January 2024, obliges businesses to display merchant accounts and halves the tax on electronic transfers to 0.1 per cent, and no take-up under it is reported. Chad runs no domestic instant payment system of its own, taking part instead in GIMACPAY, the CEMAC-wide platform operated by GIMAC and owned overwhelmingly by the regional central bank.

Identity crosses the border more easily than data does. CEMAC's Additional Act No. 01/13 of 25 June 2013 abolished visas for all CEMAC nationals, so Chadians travel within the six-country zone on national identity documents that member states must issue as biometric documents to ICAO standards — with no formal digital identity interoperability treaty behind it.

Physically the estate barely crosses the border at all. International capacity reaches Chad through a single route to Cameroon, whose underpinning memorandum ARCEP suspended over clauses judged contrary to national digital sovereignty, and the Trans-Saharan backbone that would open a second path, via Niger to the Mediterranean, was far from complete when the government publicly pressed its contractors in March 2025. Where the state does reach outward it follows the corridor: the e-BNFT transport platform was launched on 3 August 2026 in Douala, before Chadian hauliers, freight forwarders and drivers urged to enrol en masse — registering its transport operators where the trade route puts them rather than on its own territory. N'Djamena hosted a sub-regional ARTAC, ITU and ARCEP workshop on mapping Central Africa's fibre-optic infrastructure in December 2025. The Central African internet governance forum closed at N'Djamena on 15 October 2026 with a declaration calling for harmonised data-protection, cybercrime and electronic-communications law and cheaper transit, a regional anti-cyberattack platform by August 2027 among its priorities, and the government committed to support the forum's three-year action plan.

Standards

Chad publishes almost no technical standards of its own. There is no government interoperability framework or data-exchange arrangement, and none of the operational standards — data quality, service availability, legacy-system retirement — are in place or published (2025); there is no electronic government procurement system; and there is no government cloud platform and no policy governing where government data may be hosted. Systems are accordingly specified one at a time. A national standards agency does work under the standardisation law: its quality management committee adopted ten international standards as draft national norms on 5 August 2026, and ISO lists it as a correspondent member observing 7 technical committees (October 2026).

What shared standards apply come from the region or from the regulator. Chad is one of the six CEMAC states covered by the GIMAC interoperable QR code standard, validated by the UMAC ministerial committee in April 2026 and launched on 29 July 2026. ARCEP inaugurated real-time monitoring platforms in June 2026 covering traffic, spectrum, quality of service and VSAT, giving it a measurement of operator performance that is not the operators'. ADETIC, ANSICE and TECHSO-GROUP signed a tripartite agreement on 5 February 2026 to audit and certify the National Data Centre against critical-infrastructure security standards, the first certification of a state facility on the record.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Chad's media regulator has stopped licensing online newspapers. HAMA suspended examination of applications to create online newspapers "jusqu'à nouvel ordre" (August 2026), presenting the freeze as an application of its 2026-2028 strategic plan and its axis of "assainir le milieu professionnel", after denouncing a proliferation of pages on social networks passing themselves off as online media and carrying false or defamatory content. The freeze carries no end date, no published criteria for resumption and no stated treatment of applications already filed, and the promised study of new governance arrangements, to be run with all stakeholders, has no published consultation route or submission channel. The regulator has consulted before: it put lighter draft licensing specifications for web radio and web television to the public hearing the audiovisual law requires in November 2024, and no adopted text is held. The sector association AMET, whose president Bello Bakary Mana calls professional online media "a lever for democracy and citizen participation", welcomed the action against fake pages while drawing the press-freedom line the communiqué did not.

The formal channels are narrow. There is no government e-participation platform and none of the five further participation mechanisms (2025), and Participation is Chad's second worst-scoring IIAG sub-category at 15.4 out of 100, 48th of 54, and its steepest decline, 13.1 points lost over 2014-2023, driven by Civil Society Space falling 24.8 points to 11.6 (2023); Accountability and Transparency scores worse still, 13.6 and 50th of 54. One measure moved the other way: Deliberative and Participatory Governance, which tracks whether the state consults before deciding, rose 5.5 points to 30.1. The one standing multi-stakeholder mechanism is the national internet governance forum, created in 2014 and carrying no binding consultation mandate, and a national forum devoted to artificial intelligence was in preparation in August 2026.

Argument therefore lands in the chamber. Deputies used the October 2025 telecom ratification debate to press the minister on why the market would not support a new internet operator and on what basis Starlink's concession had been granted without a public call for candidates, and in April 2026 warned that inappropriate use of biometric data could harm citizens' integrity and privacy — the law passing regardless. The Economic, Social, Cultural and Environmental Council gave its 6 August 2026 session to the digital economy and artificial intelligence, questioning the former digital economy minister on data protection, cybersecurity and AI governance. One right of audience predates all this: under the 2014 telecommunications law, standing to trigger enforcement against an operator extends beyond the regulator to professional bodies, user associations and affected persons, and ARCEP may publish the notice and its lifting. The Council adopted its recommendations on 19 August, calling for a national digitalisation policy of wider scope, a durable financing mechanism for the sector, adequate power supply and specialised digital training.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Chad has started repaying the Chinese loan behind its national data centre before the centre has entered service: the telecommunications minister told a project review on 19 May 2026 that repayment of the modernisation programme's financing had begun, while the Huawei-built centre, finished and equipped, still awaited certification.

The digital lines of the 2026 budget come to XAF 18.3 billion proposed, 17.6% of it the state's own, against 18.3% of XAF 20.1 billion appropriated in 2025 (FY2026).

External money carries the rest. The 2026 budget puts XAF 9.08 billion of loan money on the ICT modernisation project and XAF 2.77 billion of grant on the digital transformation programme (FY2026), against XAF 11.06 billion of grant on that programme in 2025 (FY2025), and the fourth-quarter execution report records XAF 13.98 billion of

the digital ministry's XAF 14.31 billion of grants forecast for 2025 as mobilised (2025). The World Bank's digital transformation project closes on 30 April 2029, after which operations and maintenance costs and further bandwidth purchases fall to the government.

The state's own lines are small and mostly equipment. The 2026 budget gives XAF 400 million to the cybersecurity agency ANSICE, XAF 600 million to computerising the finance ministry and XAF 569.5 million to digitising the management of military pensioners (FY2026), against XAF 2.02 billion for the finance ministry's computerisation in 2025 (FY2025). The African Development Fund's public-administration modernisation programme, signed in August 2026, carries the state's share as a UA 1.015 million contribution in kind beside a UA 9.52 million grant.

What the law puts on others is aimed at the regulator and the network. The 2014 electronic communications law finances ARCEP from operators' contribution of 3.5% of their annual turnover to its administrative costs, with spectrum and numbering fees, and operators also finance the universal service fund FSUCE, which ADETIC manages and which had paid for no more than a pilot of three rural telecentres (2023). The identity card has been a paid service again since 3 August 2023.

MoUs and other agreements

The most consequential agreement of the past year is one that is not in force: the regulator ARCEP suspended the April 2025 memorandum underpinning the N'Djamena–Mberé fibre link to Cameroon over clauses judged contrary to national digital sovereignty, and by February 2026 the government was pressing Sotel Tchad and Airtel to fast-track a revised text.

Little else that has been signed carries money or a timetable. ANATS and the International Organization for Migration signed a memorandum in May 2026 on secure identity for vulnerable populations and migrants, building on the SIGPTS system. ARCEP signed a space cooperation memorandum with Azerbaijan's Azercosmos in January 2026 covering satellite connectivity and remote sensing for areas fibre does not reach, and an Azerbaijani ICT delegation visited ADETIC the following month to discuss data centres and digital infrastructure. The International Finance Corporation's partnership with the Chadian fintech Cashi, announced in March 2026, is an intention to build an interoperable payments platform connecting banks and mobile money operators rather than a platform. A government mission to Washington from 23 to 31 May 2026 met the State and Commerce Departments and the firms Starlink, InterSystems, Cybastion, Vertiv and 19Labs across connectivity, cybersecurity and digital health.

The agreement that plainly binds is the oldest of them: Chad and China signed a preferential loan framework agreement for the ICT Modernization Project on 26 June 2019, between the Chinese Ambassador, Li Jinjin, and Chad's Minister of Economy and Development Planning, Issa Dubrani, with the concessional loan agreement signed the same day.

New investments

Chinese state finance accounts for roughly three-fifths of the money committed to Chad's digital estate — about USD 243 million of the USD 410 million on record (2026), against USD 139 million from the World Bank across three projects and USD 27 million from the African Development Bank across two. Eight commitments make up that record, running from 2017 to 2029. Connectivity takes the bulk of it; most of the money is concessional, but the largest single line is debt.

That concentration is one project: China Eximbank's government concessional loan for the ICT Modernization Project, RMB 1.316 billion or CFA 111.4 billion — about USD 189 million at signature — signed on 26 June 2019 and approved unanimously by Parliament on 30 April 2020. On its 2019 terms it runs 20 years at 2 per cent with a five-

year grace period, collateralised against a minimum cash balance in an escrow account. A separate RMB 170 million Chinese grant, about USD 28 million, followed in 2019, both financing one engineering and construction contract with Huawei. The project was originally to complete on 31 October 2021.

The World Bank's Chad Digital Transformation Project is an SDR 69.5 million IDA grant, about USD 92 million, running 2024 to 2029 across infrastructure, digital government and financial services. Two earlier operations have closed: a USD 12 million statistical development project (2017 to 2022) and a USD 35 million revenue-administration digitalisation project (2018 to 2023).

African Development Bank money is moving slowly: its microfinance and digital financial services project for women and young entrepreneurs opened with a UA 9.7 million Transition Support Facility grant in December 2021, since topped up to commitments of XDR 10,173,150.53, about USD 14 million, but disbursements had reached only XDR 2,062,292.94 across fourteen transactions by June 2026. On 20 August 2026 Chad signed a further African Development Fund grant of UA 9.52 million, about CFA 7.3 billion, for the first phase of PAACAMA, its 2026-2030 programme to modernise public administration and improve the business climate, and the same day two Chinese grant agreements totalling RMB 300 million, about USD 44 million, naming digital technologies among their targets alongside infrastructure, social development and skills. The ITU's Central African ICT benchmarking project, which named Chad among eight countries, closed in 2023.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Chad reaches the rest of the internet through one route, and in February 2026 it was not working: the government was pressing Sotel Tchad and Airtel to fast-track a revised agreement on the N'Djamena–Mberé link to Cameroon after the regulator ARCEP suspended the underpinning memorandum over clauses it judged contrary to national digital sovereignty — and that link is the landlocked country's only entry point for international submarine-cable capacity. The second corridor, Chad's section of the Trans-Saharan backbone toward Niger, stood at 32% complete in March 2025, and a January 2026 inspection mission found vandalism and degradation at the Bol technical site in Lac province.

Take-up has not moved. 13.2% of the population used the internet in October 2025, on 2.79 million users, the same rate as a year earlier. Mobile connections equal 73.3% of the population, but those are active SIMs rather than people: ITU put unique mobile-phone penetration at 44.3% in 2024, and only 8.6% of adults owned a smartphone that year. Coverage runs well ahead of use — about 60% of the population lay under a 4G network in 2023 — and what capacity exists is thin, at roughly 21 kbit/s of international bandwidth per user in 2022. Chad's IIAG Internet & Computers score of 5.5 out of 100 was the fourth worst of that index's 96 indicators in 2023.

The state's answer is PMICE, the connectivity modernisation programme launched in July 2020 with Huawei as contractor and financed by a 111 billion FCFA China Eximbank loan. Operators were ordered under a seven-day ultimatum in September 2025 to connect to the national fibre network, and the first phase, covering the national data centre, a 1,200 km backbone and the state operator's mobile sites, was provisionally accepted at Sarh on 20 December 2025. Starlink runs on a multiservice ISP licence granted on application without a public tender. In June 2026 the government rejected fuel supply as a justification for the deteriorating quality of Airtel's and Moov's mobile services, while around 500 localities remain cut off from the network or without basic digital services, the outstanding challenge named for the World Bank-financed PATN programme.

The minister told German, European and cooperation-agency representatives on 9 October 2026 that the country has about 6,000 km of optical fibre and aims for 14,000 km.

Data Storage

Chad's National Data Centre is built and not yet open. ADETIC, the cybersecurity agency ANSICE and the firm TECHSO-GROUP signed a tripartite agreement on 5 February 2026 to audit and certify it against critical-infrastructure security standards before it opens, together with 100 micro data centres to be deployed across government institutions and interconnected with it. It is a four-storey building in N'Djamena, the first phase of PMICE, a €175.1m programme whose first phase the ministry declared complete and provisionally accepted on 20 December 2025 and which is financed by a concessional Export-Import Bank of China loan of about 111.4 billion FCFA repayable over 20 years at 2% interest. Huawei built it, with GOLF/Gulf Consulting supervising the works. ADETIC's director general describes it as a strategic base for sovereign housing of state data and the minister toured it with a Chinese delegation in January 2025 as a step toward digital sovereignty. Its power supply sits on a grid that reaches barely a tenth of the population.

Until it opens there is almost nothing. The commercial market consists of one small facility, a 374 m², 400 kW modular colocation centre built for Tigo Chad in N'Djamena in 2016, with no higher-tier commercial site identified, and no hyperscale or regional cloud provider runs an availability zone near enough to serve the country, leaving Chadian users on distant regions at latencies above 100ms.

Government has no arrangements of its own to speak of: no cloud platform, no policy governing where government data may be hosted, and nothing published about its hosting as at 2025. Nor does any localisation rule oblige data to be held in the country, so the sovereignty the data centre is framed around rests on a building rather than on law. An Azerbaijani ICT delegation visited ADETIC in February 2026 to discuss data centre collaboration.

Energy

In June 2026 the government rejected fuel supply as a justification for poor network quality and told Moov Africa Chad to solve its fuel supply or move its transmission sites to solar or wind power as it saw fit — a telecoms instruction that is really an admission about the grid.

Around 12% of Chad's population had access to electricity in 2023, among the lowest rates in the world, and that access is almost entirely urban: 48% of the urban population against under 1% of the rural population in 2023, a gap of some 48 percentage points. Access to Energy is among Chad's ten worst-scoring IIAG indicators at 8.4 out of 100, 50th of 54 in 2023, and the wider Infrastructure sub-category, which bundles transport, energy and communications, is one of the country's three worst at 17.5 out of 100. A connection is not a steady one: the most recent Enterprise Survey round recorded an average of 4.5 outages a month, with 70% of firms affected, figures dating from 2018. Generation is about 5% renewable, the rest oil-fired thermal, on 2021 data. The government's own energy compact of December 2024 records 487 MW installed against 235 MW available and a generation mix 90 per cent thermal, and after a fire at the Farcha plant in late July 2026 load-shedding in parts of the capital ran for close to a month.

Policy runs ahead of delivery. Chad has an approved national electrification plan that explicitly provides for decentralised mini-grid and off-grid solutions for productive uses and community facilities, scoring 67 of 100 on RISE's off-grid framework and 44 on its minigrids framework, with the World Bank-financed Energy Access Scale-Up Project (approved 2022, about US$28.5 million) rolling out mini-grids and standalone solar in secondary cities and rural areas. The water and energy minister travelled to China in January 2026 to advance solar mini-grids for five cities, working with the World Bank and a Chinese supplier. Electricity is the first of the three constraints named against the government's own cashless public finance mandate in January 2026, ahead of uneven internet coverage and digital literacy.

Technical Capacity

Chad's biometric identity platform runs on technology supplied by the French vendor Idemia, and the technical base that would have to take it over is two tech hubs. The private technology base is embryonic, with very limited local start-up activity and only two small tech hubs nationally as at 2023, and tertiary ICT teaching is confined to a small number of computer science programmes at the country's principal public university, with minimal research output behind them. A national higher school of information and communication technologies, a public establishment created in 2015, graduated 121 students in its fifth cohort in December 2025.

Inside government the position is thinner still. As at 2025 there was no dedicated digital government institution and no machinery coordinating or auditing government technology across ministries, no digital skills programme for public servants, and neither a civil service human resource management information system nor a payroll system — so the state cannot administer its own wage bill on a recognised system, let alone build the systems it is buying. Public administration is Chad's strongest sub-category within the IIAG's economic opportunity group, but the effectiveness of the administration itself fell over 2014-2023, and that bureaucracy is what every digitisation programme has to run through.

Cybersecurity

Chad now has a legal class of entities of vital digital importance: an ordinance ratified in March 2026 established the classification and expanded the cybersecurity agency's regulatory, investigative and enforcement powers, alongside a broadened ANSICE mandate reaching beyond cybersecurity into electronic-transaction security, cybercrime, the national information space and the regulation of video-surveillance systems and drones. The statutory base underneath it remains Law No. 009/PR/2015 on cybersecurity and the fight against cybercrime, which is also the instrument the country relies on for digital signatures, digital identification and payments.

Capability sits behind the mandate. The ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index 2024 places Chad in tier 4, "Evolving", the second-lowest of its five tiers. ANSICE's visible work is episodic rather than systematic: a videoconference with the United States CISA in January 2025 on threat monitoring, engineer capacity and critical-infrastructure protection, and the February 2026 agreement with ADETIC and TECHSO-GROUP to audit and certify the National Data Centre before it opens. There is no statutory duty on any data controller to notify breaches or unauthorised access, so the agency governs an estate whose incidents nobody is obliged to tell it about.

The institutional lines are drawn oddly. ADETIC, whose remit is digital infrastructure, extended it to equipping the national police for cybercrime work in a handover on 20 July 2026: the agency that builds the state's networks is also outfitting the force that polices what runs over them, with no oversight arrangement described for the dual role. At the other end, the media regulator HAMA stated on 3 August 2026 that offences committed on digital platforms do not fall within its competence and belong exclusively to the judicial authorities under the Penal Code and the cybercrime law. Telecom oversight gained its own instrumentation when ARCEP inaugurated real-time monitoring platforms in June 2026 covering traffic, spectrum, quality of service and VSAT. The women and early-childhood ministry banned sending official correspondence, reports and administrative decisions over messaging applications, making a breach a disciplinary fault, by a circular reported on 25 September 2026.

DPI

Data Exchange

Chad's first working data exchange has been assembled inside the public finance chain rather than across the state: on 1 April 2026 the tax directorate and the treasury and public accounting directorate signed a protocol establishing automated real-time exchange of data on assessments, collections, arrears and payments, set inside a digitalisation

of the whole public finance chain running through SIGFiP, e-Tax and standardised electronic invoicing. Three weeks earlier the Ministry of Finance and the National Agency for Secure Documents signed a protocol allowing secure real-time consultation of the national biometric population register for identity verification, the first connection of its kind to it, and in May 2026 Airtel's SIM registration data was interconnected with the same registry.

None of it rests on a framework. Chad has no government interoperability framework, and none of the operational standards that would accompany one — data quality, service availability, the retirement of legacy systems — is in place (2025), and the 2015 package of digital-economy laws establishes no authority for cross-government data sharing. Back-office systems were built in silos and no transactional digital service faces an end user (2024), and they were funded separately and built on no common technical or security standards, which prevents them from exchanging data or providing integrated services (2023). As at 2025 the tax administration's own system exchanged data with no other government system, and no health information system is integrated into a government-wide exchange (2025).

The 2027 budget orientations would put interoperability at the centre of public finance: the tax, customs and Treasury systems are to be interconnected with budget preparation and execution, public accounting and the cadastre, land and identity platforms, and no ministry is to put in place a system incompatible with those already running.

Separately, TCHADIX, the national internet exchange point run by ADETIC, marked its first year of operation in May 2026, holding national traffic off international routes.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Only three per cent of Chadians over twelve held a national identity card when the World Bank appraised the identity system (2023). The system behind it is SIGPTS, introduced in 2020 and run by the National Agency for Secure Documents (ANATS), which issues the national identification number through its biometric population register module alongside the national ID card and the passport (2023), on biometric technology supplied by Idemia. Its population register module has issued National Refugee Identification Numbers since a World Bank-funded pilot opened in N'Djamena (May 2025).

Enrolment does not start at birth. It begins at around age twelve (2023), and the refugee programme beside it at ten (2025), so younger children hold no biometric credential even where a birth has been registered. Nor is the card free: the fee was cut to 5,000 CFA francs in January 2020, waived from December 2022, then reinstated from 3 August 2023, with a half-price rate announced in June 2024 for students and people with disabilities. The refugee pilot run with the refugee commission, UNHCR and the World Bank had issued more than 4,000 refugee identification numbers in N'Djamena by 1 May 2025, against 7,000 targeted for the pilot area and 25,000 across its later phases, to close a gap whereby existing refugee documents were not accepted for bank accounts or SIM registration.

What the credential reaches is broad but shallow. The card is the recognised basis for proving identity and is accepted for government services and banking checks, but it is not the sole mandatory credential for opening a bank account, obtaining healthcare or registering for social assistance (2023). The number is required on paper: the 2023 finance law demands it to open a bank account, register with social protection or subscribe to utilities, and makes it the connection key of every automated administrative system, and biometric enrolment of state agents against it was launched in March 2023 to find fictitious civil servants; no figure on either is published. The government intends the register to become the identification layer that public and private bodies connect to instead of keeping their own identity silos, and in May 2026 ANATS and Airtel Chad signed a partnership for mass enrolment and the securing of population data, with the Ministry of Public Security and the National Police present at the signing.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Chad now has three licensed payment institutions — Airtel Money, licensed in 2023, the domestic fintech Konoom in 2025 and Moov Money Tchad in 2026 — and with them a change of supervisor, as oversight of the mass-market mobile-money rails migrates from the telecoms regulator to the regional banking supervisor COBAC, whose licence carries bank-grade capital, solvency, cybersecurity-audit and client-money obligations.

Use remains among the thinnest in the region. Active mobile money use runs at about 13% of the population (2025), against 55% in Cameroon, and BEAC recorded FCFA 526.7 billion of mobile transactions in Chad at end-2024. The regional central bank's 2021 baseline put access to financial services at 23% of adults and the inclusion rate on active accounts at 6%. Bank rails are thinner still, at 9.0 out of 100 on the Ibrahim Index's access to banking measure, 43rd of 54 (2023). What the wallets do carry is transfers, merchant payments and bills — electricity, water, school fees (2024), and Konoom's wallet is reachable by app, web, USSD without internet and WhatsApp (2026).

There is no domestic instant payment system: Chad participates in GIMACPAY, the CEMAC-wide platform launched commercially in July 2020 and owned about 99.2% by the regional central bank BEAC, which also settles it, where transactions inside the zone are treated identically whether domestic or cross-border and settle through BEAC's SYGMA system once a day (2025); its scheme rules are not published (2023). Chad is covered by the CEMAC interoperable QR code standard adopted in April 2026 and routed through GIMACPAY. The regional central bank has acceded to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, with member-state banks to connect by the end of 2026.

The state is pushing hardest on money coming in. A 2025 circular bars revenue agencies from collecting state revenue in cash, taxpayers have been able to declare and pay online through the e-Tax platform since January 2023, and 3,000 electronic payment terminals were handed to the Ministry of Finance on 24 July 2026, with no deployment schedule or per-agency allocation stated. Money going out barely moves: 0.1% of adults receive government payments in digital form, against 176,798 active mobile money accounts in 2021 (2023). The telecoms and digital economy minister set out a transformation of the state postal operator, with a postal bank in the medium term and an integrated payment platform, no budget or date stated (2026). N'Djamena's city council told suppliers on 29 September 2026 that their invoices must be standardised electronic invoices where they are liable, under a finance ministry circular of 10 September, and that non-compliant invoices may go unpaid. A press account of September 2026 finds the terminals deployed in the revenue offices and their use held back by power cuts, thin provincial connectivity and agents' limited skills.

Registries

Chad ranks seventh in Africa on the Ibrahim Index's civil registration measure, at 75.0 out of 100 and up 12.5 points over 2014-2023 — a score for the legal and institutional framework rather than for what it produces. Birth registration reached 25.5% of children under five, 50% in urban areas against 21.1% in rural ones, with death and marriage registration almost non-existent (2019).

The civil register runs on text messages: registry offices, hospitals, vaccination centres, municipalities, mobile units, refugee camps and schools transmit records by SMS to ANATS, which validates them and sends them back for issuance. Campaigns have registered over 120,000 children through hospital-based registry offices and over 180,000 pupils through schools since 2023 (2025), and a national operation with UNICEF launched on 24 July 2026 runs a first six-month phase across twelve provinces, counting children household by household and registering pupils at the start of the school year. Five years after the TASDJIL application was introduced, UNICEF and the civil status directorate issued new monthly paper forms for collecting and transmitting civil-status data at a workshop in August 2026.

The other registers stand apart from one another. The Unified Social Registry held 684,500 households in September 2025 but does not use the national biometric identifier as its key, which limits matching (2025). The biometric voter register, 7,388,348 voters as of 2021 and updated across seven southern provinces in 2023, is compiled independently of the national population register. The courts are not connected to the register either: a workshop on 25 February 2026 was convened to lay the groundwork for an interconnection between the Tribunaux de Grande Instance and the national biometric population register, and for access to the late-registration judgments they issue. There is no national digital cadastre, only pilots (2023); land titles began moving onto the E-Conservation system from 2023 while recording stayed largely on paper, and the land one-stop shop's online file system, GIRAF, was restored in December 2022 after an outage in 2021, with a pilot in two zones collecting parcel data to feed it from January 2026; company registration is handled manually (2026); and the taxpayer register is assessed by the IMF as incomplete and not yet reliable (2024). The newest is e-BNFT, which took enrolment of road-freight operators online on 3 August 2026. Company creation is moving: the investment agency, which describes an online platform for company creation as set up, signed a convention on 18 September 2026 to take creation fees by mobile money. The youth and sports ministry launched an online register of sports federations and youth associations on 4 September 2026.

Sectoral management information systems

Chad has no civil service human resource management system and no payroll system, so the public wage bill is not administered on one (2025). Money is better served: a commercial financial management system is in use for treasury execution, at central government level only, alongside a commercial public debt management system (2025), while the tax administration runs custom-built software that exchanges data with nothing else (2025). Tax administration sits on SIGTAS, launched in 2015, and the E.Tax platform of the Direction Générale des Impôts, covering personal and business taxes (2026), and Finance Law 2026 makes e-Tax use exclusive and mandatory, requires electronic invoicing and provides for automated data interconnections between the tax administration and specified institutions.

Half of the ten core back-office government systems tracked are in use — financial management, tax, customs, social insurance and debt management — and half are absent. Of the four whose software type is recorded, three are commercial off-the-shelf products and only the tax system is custom-built.

In the line ministries the systems are national at the top and paper at the bottom. The health management information system runs on DHIS2, with almost all health districts reporting into it (2022), while health centres send monthly activity reports that a district officer keys into the platform, as an audit found on site in the districts it visited in August 2024. The education management information system has collected data from schools since 2009 and produces an annual statistical yearbook whose contents do not reliably reach school principals or local inspectors (2026); its functions have been decentralised to 16 of 23 provinces across a system of 12,863 primary schools (2025), and the returns move on paper, the questionnaires printed in five copies and carried down and back up through provincial delegation, departmental inspectorate and zone inspectorate to the school directors (2021). An EU-funded UNESCO project supports teacher-management software modelled on Senegal's MIRADOR (February 2025).

Justice and policing are at pilot stage. An e-Justice platform launched with United Nations development support in October 2025 links litigants and lawyers to the judicial system through a public extranet and an intranet for judicial staff, with N'Djamena as its pilot jurisdiction, and the EU-funded, INTERPOL-implemented police information system was still renovating its data collection centre and rolling out fingerprint identification in mid-2025, with the project

extended to December 2025. A press account reported the national digital health strategic plan for 2025 to 2030 validated at a meeting led by the health minister (2024). The World Health Organization's regional platform for digitising health campaigns was piloted in a district of N'Djamena province during the June 2026 polio campaign.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

There is no national government service portal in Chad, and none of the six capabilities that would go with one, including any means for citizens to take part in designing the services (2025); the country scored 0.1785 on the UN's E-Government Development Index in 2024, 189th of 193. Nor is there any e-participation channel or central feedback and grievance platform (2025), or any electronic government procurement system (2025).

What exists instead is a scatter of single-purpose platforms. The National Employment Promotion Office runs a site where job seekers register, maintain CVs and receive vacancy alerts, and opened a salaried-employment window in June 2025; it links to no other administrative database. Businesses and taxpayers can file and pay through the e-Tax platform, whose use the 2026 finance law makes exclusive and mandatory; road-freight operators can enrol through e-BNFT, launched on 3 August 2026; litigants and lawyers in the capital can use the e-Justice pilot; and notarial acts moved onto e-Notaire, launched by the finance ministry in December 2024 with no usage figure published. None of them shares a front door or an identity check: as at 2023 there was no gateway through which a citizen could authenticate with a digital ID, and no government-to-person or government-to-business transactional service.

The ambition outruns the machinery, since Chad has no dedicated digital government institution and nothing coordinating or auditing government technology across ministries (2025). One service already carries volume: the National Police said in October 2026 that the e-Visa platform takes more than 100 applications a day, against fewer than 10 at its launch in December 2024, and has been mandatory for travellers who need a visa since 11 May 2026. The 2027 budget orientations would nonetheless make e-Visa the sole channel for applying for, paying for and receiving a visa, take business creation online end to end, from filing and fees to identifiers and the delivery of documents, and require public bodies to pay only by electronic transfer to final beneficiaries against standardised electronic invoices from the start of 2027. A platform the government calls its sovereign data platform is in use for tracking delivery of the president's programme, and the Prime Minister received a two-year report drawn from it on 7 August 2026.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The digital state stops at the centre: less than half the population has access to broadband connectivity, and outside N'Djamena and the secondary cities there is no grid electrification at all (2023), while the financial management system covering treasury execution runs at central government level only (2025). Budget orientations published in August 2026 propose generalising SIGFiP to local authorities, public establishments, projects and missions abroad for real-time monitoring of budget execution, with no rollout date attached.

What exists below the national level is programme-specific, and mostly someone else's programme. Education has the widest reach, with management information functions decentralised to two-thirds of the provinces and the remainder to follow (2025), though that concerns compiling and using data at province level rather than what the schools themselves record. Civil status is where local administration is most exposed: N'Djamena city hall and ANATS signed a memorandum on 23 September 2026 launching a project, supported by the Organisation Internationale de la Francophonie, to digitise the commune's civil registers and connect its systems securely to ANATS's population and secure-documents system, after interoperability work between the three began in April 2026, and a one-stop registration office opened at Bol in Lake province in November 2023, putting registration

alongside the health facilities that notify births. The Abéché town hall, the provincial telecommunications delegation and the ICT agency met on 15 September 2026 on a partnership to digitise municipal services, with no service or budget published.

The measure of how far that has travelled is what was handed to officials at Sarh on 7-8 August 2026: new monthly paper forms for collecting and transmitting civil-status data, five years after the TASDJIL application was introduced. Registration coverage differs sharply between neighbouring southern provinces under the same statute, the same fee waiver and the same national campaign (August 2026). Where the centre does reach into the provinces it tends to go around the local administration rather than through it: the July 2026 registration campaign associates administrative and traditional authorities with the enrolment to vouch for its reliability while the enrolment itself is run by ANATS teams.

Rural digital data capture

Outside N'Djamena the routine administrative record is still made on paper, and most of what is captured digitally is captured because a donor put a device in someone's hand: rural primary schools return enrolment and attendance on questionnaires printed in five paper copies and carried down and back up through provincial delegation, departmental inspectorate and zone inspectorate (2021), and rural clinics collect data on paper registers and forms, with entry of the monthly report made at the health district (2022). The refugee agency runs a second education data system of the same name for the camps and settlements, on different tools from the ministry's (2021), and the government was still relying on talks with technology providers to narrow the rural digital divide under Tchad Connexion 2030 (December 2025).

The one national system built for reach runs on text messages: civil registry offices, hospitals, vaccination centres, municipalities, mobile units, refugee camps and schools pass registration data to ANATS by SMS, which validates it and returns it for issuance. The child registration operation under way in July 2026 equips teams recruited from within the communities with smartphones, working household to household with the data fed into the national biometric register. Health capture has moved the same way in places: a tablet-based consultation record piloted in southern Chad is being extended into southern health districts, and solar-powered telemedicine kiosks reach remote areas (2025). Each is a programme with an owner outside the administration rather than a service the state itself runs.

The constraints sit underneath all of it: rural electricity access is close to nil against a substantial urban rate (2023), 4G coverage stops well short of the population and use far short of coverage (2023), and Lac province spent months without any internet at all after October 2024. Rural policy scores better than that record suggests — Rural Economy Support is among Chad's ten most improved governance indicators, up 23.7 points over 2014-2023 to 53.4 out of 100, while Rural Land & Water Access fell 11.4 points to 40.6 (2023) — but that is a scoring of policy and institutions, not of what gets recorded at the point it happens.

Technology

AI

Chad's artificial-intelligence governance sits in a ministry directorate and in its cybersecurity agency: a presidential decree of 21 October 2025 created a directorate-general for artificial intelligence inside the digital ministry, and the reform of ANSICE approved in March 2026 gave the agency a mandate carrying provisions on social media, digital services and artificial-intelligence systems. Little is running behind them — no artificial intelligence or advanced analytics is in use in any government data-exchange or interoperability system, and basic interoperability between ministries has not been achieved (2024), so there are no data-quality, fraud-detection or predictive applications to

govern. The Economic, Social, Cultural and Environmental Council took up the digital economy and artificial intelligence at its session of 6 August 2026, questioning a former minister on data protection, cybersecurity and AI governance ahead of its recommendations to government. The Council adopted its recommendations on 19 August 2026. Two pilots are on record, both in health: a computer-aided tuberculosis screening programme that screened 7,116 people, and an analytical layer over the health information system for vaccination planning, launched on 2 April 2026 in three provinces.

Chad has no artificial-intelligence strategy and no artificial-intelligence law.

A pre-validation workshop for the National Artificial Intelligence Strategy opened in N'Djamena on 8 October 2026, the strategy aimed at health, agriculture, education and public services.

ICT Industry

Chad's business and labour environment scored 31.9 out of 100 in the Ibrahim Index, 47th of 54 African countries (2023), flat across the decade, with the business and competition regulations component down 13.3 points to 43.3 — the terms on which a technology firm would register and operate got worse, not better. There is no startup or innovation law, and no government financing or SME support for technology firms (2025). Commercial activity amounts to a few dozen registered companies, concentrated in fintech, e-commerce and digital services (2025), and Chad has run no business or establishment survey in the ten years to 2023, so the firm sector has never been enumerated.

The state's own systems are bought in rather than built.

Innovation ecosystem

Chad is not among the 133 economies ranked in the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024, absent from the global innovation and entrepreneurship indexes for want of the data needed to place it. Its incubator base is two hubs, both in N'Djamena — Wenaklabs, the first, founded in 2014, and Chad Innovation, running since 2018 and affiliated to the pan-African AfriLabs network — with nothing documented outside the capital; Wenaklabs hosts the Francophonie's D-CLIC programme, launched in April 2026 as Makers Tchad. Ventures do come out of this and reach users: Telemedan, founded by the Chadian entrepreneur Abakar Mahamat, delivers healthcare to remote parts of the country through solar-powered telemedicine kiosks and is backed by the Ministry of Health and the World Bank (2025), and Konoom, an N'Djamena payments startup launched in 2025, holds a COBAC licence for its wallet. Of the companies trackers record, a minority have raised venture or private-equity money, in fintech, e-commerce and digital services (2025). Behind them the state has since put two instruments in place. A technology innovation centre created by arrêté of 1 September 2025 and publicly launched on 30 October, covering a digital library, incubation of Chadian technology start-ups, research and development laboratories, digital-skills training and the digitalisation of the administration, and a youth entrepreneurship fund created by Loi n. 005/PR/MFB/2020 and launched in July 2020 at 30 billion FCFA, lending entirely through banks under a 70 per cent state guarantee at a target rate of about 6.25 per cent, with information and communication technology among eligible sectors. Neither publishes a tenant list, a cohort size or a disbursement total, and a governance review of 2025 had recorded no public-sector innovation programme or strategy at all.

Capacity

Literacy

Chad's schooling floor is among the lowest on the continent and has fallen rather than risen: education enrolment scored 21.2 out of 100 in 2023, 48th of 54 African countries and 1.2 points below its level a decade earlier, with completion at 14.4 and equality in education at 22.3. Education is nonetheless one of the country's more improved governance sub-categories over 2014 to 2023, though it still ranked 49th of 54 in 2023. This is the pool from which the users and the operators of any digital system in Chad have to be drawn.

Above that floor, internet access is uneven between urban areas and rural regions, and strengthening technical skills sits among the central drivers named for the transition (December 2025), and no government programme reaches into schools or the wider population to close them (2025). The systems that do run on schools are administrative rather than instructional: the education management information system has collected data from schools since 2009 and produces an annual statistical yearbook whose contents do not reliably reach school principals and local inspectors, and its functions have been decentralised to two-thirds of the provinces (2025). A large share of pupils attend school with no document attesting their legal existence at all (2024).

The one national plan that names literacy places it in the future: the payment-terminal programme running under Tchad Connexion 2030 is to be followed by digital and financial literacy work, public digital centres and rural connectivity (July 2026).

Training and skills

Chad has no digital skills programme for its public servants — no strategy, no programme, and no reach into schools or the wider citizenry (2025). What training exists is run and paid for by outside bodies.

The Organisation internationale de la Francophonie launched its D-CLIC programme in Chad in April 2026 as "Makers Tchad — Jeunesse et innovation pour l'emploi", hosted at the N'Djamena innovation hub Wenaklabs, teaching fabrication and connected-device skills including CNC machining and the internet of things. In the east, UNHCR inaugurated a digital learning centre at the Abéché one-stop shop in February 2025, funded by Italy, for refugee and host-community young people. Both of the country's identifiable technology hubs sit in the capital, so provision outside N'Djamena depends on whichever agency chooses to place a centre there.

At least three separate donor-funded programmes carry the country's digital skills training — the OIF's Makers Tchad, the PDMFI financial-inclusion training and UNHCR's Abéché learning centre — and the two that publish participant numbers come to roughly 270 trainees (2026).

Government's own training runs to single events. The ministry of higher education, research and vocational training trained its agents on the StatEduc application in July 2026, covering questionnaire configuration, deployment of data-entry masks, consistency checking and the interpretation of indicators, framed as planning infrastructure for the higher-education and vocational sector. The national administration school hosted the opening content-design workshop of a five-country project to move civil-service training online in March 2025, and the ICT agency signed a framework accord with an engineering institute in Ouagadougou to train officials in artificial intelligence and emerging technologies (July 2025); neither reports a cohort. The World Bank's digital transformation project, running to 2029, carries capacity building alongside its infrastructure and government systems components. The formal pipeline behind all of this is narrow: tertiary ICT education is confined to a small number of programmes at the Université de N'Djamena, whose Faculté des Sciences Exactes et Appliquées offers Licence and Master's

degrees in computer science (2026). Beside the university stands the national higher school of information and communication technologies, which graduated a fifth cohort of 121 in December 2025 and received 45 computers from the ICT agency in July 2026.

Research institutions

Knowledge about Chad's digital systems is produced almost entirely outside the country: the Université de N'Djamena is the only institution with computer science degree programmes, and its research output is minimal (2026). The national ICT school is also a public higher-education and research establishment, and graduated its fifth cohort in December 2025. An interdisciplinary artificial-intelligence research laboratory was created inside the national development research centre by an order of 3 August 2026, with a mandate to draw up a national AI research plan.

Inclusion

Access to services

Lac province was cut off from the internet from 28 October 2024 for more than three months, a shutdown attributed to security grounds that Internet Society Chad protested in February 2025 as isolating thousands of people from communication, education and the economy. Where the state's own channels are concerned there is little to cut off: Chad has no national government service portal, and no tax, social protection or jobs portal either (2025), so obtaining a service means presenting yourself at an office and government payments almost never reach people in digital form (2023). A resident's open letter of September 2026 describes the province's internet as still heavily restricted nearly two years on, and no restoration is on record.

The document everything starts from is the one most often missing: 829,000 pupils were attending school with no paper attesting their legal existence (2024). The obstacles are prosaic — distance from civil-status centres, cost, and simple lack of information — and the remedies are correspondingly analogue: the court fee for the jugement supplétif that substitutes for a missing birth record has been suspended (February 2026), and a registration operation launched with UNICEF works through schools and household visits (July 2026). Cost bites at the next step too, since the national identity card is a paid service (2024) and biometric enrolment does not begin until around age twelve, so a registered child holds no credential.

For refugees the barrier has been recognition rather than paper. The biometric IDs now issued replace CNARR and UNHCR credentials that local authorities, banks and service providers often did not accept, and a World Bank-funded pilot with CNARR, UNHCR and Idemia had registered refugees on SIGPTS and issued thousands of cards by May 2025. ANATS has since taken delivery of biometric enrolment equipment from UNHCR for the same push (March 2026), and UNHCR opened a digital learning centre at the Abéché one-stop shop in February 2025, funded by Italy, offering online skills training to refugee and host-community youth.

Against the continent, the improvement is real and the level is not: Equal Access to Public Services, which measures whether provision reaches all social groups and regions evenly, rose 13.1 points over 2014-2023 to 25.5 out of 100, 42nd of 54 (2023).

Digital divides

The sharpest line in Chad falls before any device is switched on: mains electricity is an urban service, reaching a minority of town dwellers and almost none of the rural population (2023). The digital effort built on top of it repeats the shape — internet access is uneven, with sharp disparities between urban areas and rural regions, and narrowing

that divide was still a matter of talks with a vendor under Tchad Connexion 2030 (December 2025). The same line runs through documentation, where birth registration is markedly more complete in towns than in the countryside (2019).

Underneath the geography sits a device and income divide that the connection figures hide. Smartphone ownership among Chadian adults is among the lowest in sub-Saharan Africa (2024), and active SIM connections run at several times the share of people who actually use the internet (October 2025), so a mobile market that looks broad is thin at the point where it matters. The Ibrahim Index's combined measure of internet use, computer access and affordability puts Chad near the bottom of the continent and among the worst-scoring indicators in the whole index (2023), and the same profile shows education participation and outcomes among Africa's weakest (2023), which bounds who can use a text interface at all.

The gender line is the one nobody has measured: GSMA's 2025 report carries a 29% mobile internet gender gap for sub-Saharan Africa as a whole and no country-level estimate for Chad (2024).

Displacement and movement add divides of their own. Refugee-hosting areas in eastern Chad have very little 4G coverage, with handset cost and literacy limiting use of mobile services further (2025). Pastoral populations sit outside routine systems by construction: the third population census runs the enumeration of herders and nomads through a dedicated national coordination role rather than through its ordinary field structure. The ICT development agency inaugurated a community multimedia centre at Moundou under the universal service programme on 29 September 2026, with no count of other centres or users published.

Data

National statistics

A decree of 20 July 2026 extended the main enumeration of Chad's third population and housing census to 6 August, past the window an earlier decree had fixed in May, giving as its reason the need to reorganise teams and run sweeps across the national territory — the government recording on the instrument itself that field coverage was incomplete at the original deadline. RGPH-3 ran through 2026, with a dedicated national coordination for enumerating herders and nomadic populations.

The production system beneath it is weakest where it collects: Chad's weakest pillars in the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators are data sources and data infrastructure, both in the 20-49% band (2023), against 70-89% for data use and data products. In the ten years to 2023 it ran household, agricultural and health surveys but no labour force survey and no business or establishment survey, and over twenty years a population census but no agricultural and no business census, so employment and the firm sector have no enumerated base.

Capacity of the Statistical System is among Chad's ten most improved Ibrahim Index indicators, up 14.0 points over 2014-2023 to 42.7 out of 100 and 35th of 54. INSEED disseminates survey and census data through its own portal while administrative data held by sector ministries — education, health, justice, civil registration and telecommunications among them — remains poorly harmonised and outside any shared government data exchange, and the higher-education ministry configures and runs its own StatEduc questionnaires with no published route into the national statistics.

Civil registration yields the most-quoted numbers and the least complete: 48.33 per cent of newborns were registered inside the three-month legal deadline (2024) and about 2.9 million children under five were undeclared that year, a count standing in for a coverage rate that still rests on a 2019 household survey. The connectivity figures

are modelled, not counted: the 2025 DataReportal edition puts internet adoption at 13.2% while recording internet users up 4.3% over the year and the adoption rate unchanged. The World Bank operation funding INSEED's collection and dissemination capacity closed in 2022.

Open data

Disclosure of Public Records is Chad's seventh most improved Ibrahim Index indicator, up 17.4 points over 2014-2023 to 35.6 out of 100 and 20th of 54, while Accessibility of Public Records — whether a citizen can obtain those records in practice — rose 1.9 points to 16.5 and 42nd of 54. More is put out; almost none of it is more reachable.

Chad has no government open data portal, and none of the supporting measures such as catalogue coverage and update frequency are recorded (2025). There is no data governance body and no data governance strategy, and nothing about how government systems handle data is published. No public dashboard, data-sharing agreement or annual report covers the operation of government data systems: the back-office systems that do exist — SIGFiP, the eTax application and ASYCUDA World for customs — are internal to individual ministries, and there is no right to information law by which anyone could compel disclosure.

The statistics institute runs its own diffusion channels beneath that whole-of-government absence, and their terms are the answer to whether Chadian public data is open. Its site lists five — an Open Data Portal, a national data summary page, a national statistical data archive, an SDG goal tracker and an indicator tracker for the national development plan, while the archive's access policy requires that microdata not be copied or transmitted to anyone without prior written agreement, that a prescribed source line be cited, and that two copies of any report produced be supplied to the institute. The material is published and it is not open.

What is published, the Open Data Inventory scores poorly. Chad's strongest categories in the 2024 inventory are agriculture and health facilities at 7 out of 10, government finance and price statistics at 6.5, and education facilities and poverty at 6 — a weak best. Population and vital statistics score 5, with education outcomes, gender, reproductive health and crime statistics all at 4.5, which matters directly for registry work that needs demographic denominators to know what coverage it has reached. Economic statistics are weaker still: international trade and labour at 3.5, balance of payments and national accounts at 4, money and banking at 5. Three of the 23 categories assessed score zero — energy, pollution, and the digital and communications category itself, so the sector this report describes publishes no open national data about itself.

Use of satellite data

The one operational use of satellite data is in weather warnings: the national meteorology agency tracks convective storms by satellite nowcasting with European partners, has shared 24 stations' data internationally every hour since October 2024, and issued 248 alert bulletins in 2025. Chad's regulator ARCEP signed a space cooperation memorandum with Azerbaijan's Azercosmos in January 2026 covering satellite connectivity and remote sensing for areas fibre does not reach — a memorandum rather than a funded deployment.

The rest is connectivity. Starlink's operating licence was approved in November 2024 and confirmed by the Ministry of Telecommunications in March 2025, and the service went commercially live on 4 July 2025 with a published tariff grid. It runs on a multiservice ISP licence rather than a mobile-operator licence, granted on application after a favourable ARCEP technical opinion and without a public tender, as the telecommunications minister told the National Assembly on 22 October 2025.

Imagery has been used in land administration only in trials: donor-supported pilots with Kadaster International, Esri and Trimble tested fit-for-purpose cadastral mapping in selected areas, and no operational national digital cadastre followed.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

A Chadian government mission spent nine days in Washington, from 23 to 31 May 2026, meeting the State and Commerce Departments and the firms Starlink, InterSystems, Cybastion, Vertiv and 19Labs across connectivity, cybersecurity and digital health.

Only one of those firms sells into Chad today. Starlink was licensed to operate in November 2024 and went commercially live on 4 July 2025, which puts the American footprint in front of retail subscribers rather than inside a state contract.

The state-to-state side is thinner and sits in cybersecurity. ANSICE and the United States Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency held a videoconference in January 2025 covering cyber-threat monitoring, engineer capacity, incident response and critical-infrastructure protection, following Chad's participation in the 2024 Counter-Ransomware Initiative summit. That contact and the Washington round sixteen months later put American agencies alongside Chad's cyber regulator without putting an American firm inside the state's own build.

China activities

China's ambassador to Chad, Wang Xining, put the dependency question himself in January 2025, asking how Chad would take ownership of the National Data Centre building and its machines in the absence of Chinese technicians. The building was still not handed over more than a year later: the ministry announced the commencement of the modernisation programme's first phase, the data centre among its works, only on 20 December 2025, and its security audit and certification were still to be carried out before launch (February 2026).

The position underneath that question is a single vendor holding the whole build. Huawei Technologies is the contractor for the National Data Centre, and the same firm is the engineering, procurement and construction contractor for the wider programme, which pairs the data centre with a national fibre backbone running south to east and a loop around N'Djamena serving the capital's mobile sites. The lending and the contracting are the same relationship seen twice: a China Eximbank concessional loan and a separate RMB 170 million Chinese government grant (2019), whose proceeds were both expected to finance one engineering, procurement and construction contract with Huawei. The loan is collateralised against a minimum cash balance held in an escrow account, which gives the lender a claim that does not depend on the network being finished. The framework agreement behind it was signed on 26 June 2019 and ratified on 20 August 2019.

Chinese state finance accounts for the larger part of all digital-sector money on record for Chad, ahead of the World Bank, the African Development Bank and the ITU combined.

The same vendor is positioned for the next programme as well: the government is stepping up the rollout of Tchad Connexion 2030, its plan for rural coverage, in talks with Huawei. The Chinese ambassador announced a programme of 5,000 scholarships in technology and artificial intelligence at a ministerial audience on 17 August 2026.

EU activities

The deepest European position in Chad is in policing data. The EU-funded, INTERPOL-implemented Chad Police Information System was still completing the renovation of its Data Collection and Registration Centre and rolling out an automated fingerprint identification system as of mid-2025, with the project extended to December 2025 — European money paying for the country's criminal biometric capability, built by an outside implementer rather than by the police themselves.

The second position is a vendor one, in identity. Idemia supplies the biometrics behind the refugee identity system: a World Bank-funded pilot run with CNARR, UNHCR and Idemia registered refugees and had issued them biometric IDs in the thousands by May 2025, and Chad was still issuing refugee cards on Idemia technology in March 2026, by which point ANATS had also received biometric enrolment equipment from UNHCR for its inclusive-identification push.

The third position is a delivered state system. Chad launched a digital Journal Officiel platform on 14 May 2026 giving free centralised online access to laws, decrees, regulatory texts and public procurement notices back to 1958, carried by the government's general secretariat with United Nations technical support and European Union funding, and in February 2026 the Cour suprême received laptops, desktops, professional scanners, server-room equipment and network hardware through the European-funded parliamentary and electoral support project. The European Investment Bank's own entry point was earlier and narrower: three feasibility studies financed in December 2020 on high-speed broadband, improved telecommunications and connectivity for remote rural communities, described by the Bank as its first targeted cooperation with the government on digitalisation and rural connectivity, whose findings are not held.

Everything else European is training, and it is small and recent. The Organisation internationale de la Francophonie launched its D-CLIC programme in Chad in April 2026 as "Makers Tchad – Jeunesse et innovation pour l'emploi", hosted at the N'Djamena innovation hub Wenaklabs, and UNHCR inaugurated an Italian-funded digital learning centre at the Abéché one-stop-shop in February 2025, offering online skills training to refugee and host-community young people in eastern Chad.

Gulf/UAE activities

The Gulf position in Chad is an agreement and a pledge rather than a system. Chad and the United Arab Emirates signed a memorandum on cybersecurity, cybercrime and international cyber cooperation on the margins of Regional Cybersecurity Week in Abu Dhabi in October 2023, the only located Gulf instrument with Chad whose defined subject is digital. The money came later and is not sector-specific: at the close of the Emirates-Chad trade and investment forum in Abu Dhabi on 10 and 11 November 2025, Chad announced 20.5 billion dollars secured against its five-year plan — 4.1 billion from forty private companies and 16.4 billion in donor pledges, and in January 2026 the President promulgated the law ratifying an Emirates-Chad investment protection agreement — pledges whose digital share is not stated, against a cooperation memorandum three years old with nothing built under it. No Gulf state, sovereign fund, operator or vendor held a recorded position in Chad's digital infrastructure, identity systems or telecommunications market as at September 2026. By September 2026 US$790.5 million of the pledges, 3.9 per cent, had been signed across seventeen companies.

India activities

Indian engagement with Chad's digital sector has not progressed past talks. Chad and India discussed digital cooperation in February 2025, with training in artificial intelligence among the areas Chad sought, and the same discussions covered support for ENASTIC, the national ICT training school, and the establishment of a postal bank. India held no operating, financing or vendor position in Chad's digital estate as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Chad is bringing in outside certifiers before its Huawei-built national data centre holds state data: the government is exploring a partnership with the American firm Cybastion to audit, certify and secure the centre before it goes into operation (July 2026), the cybersecurity agency ANSICE having already audited the security of the equipment installed (May 2026).

Until then state data sits wherever each ministry puts it. Ministries were turning to private hosting solutions (2024), and the World Bank project finances national data hosting, data migration and disaster recovery, including private cloud hosting with backup for selected ministries. The telecommunications minister announced the commissioning of two data centres in N'Djamena and a third to be built for the finance ministry (August 2026). Under the 2015 law ANSICE authorises cross-border transfers of personal data. No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026.

Access to the identity register is being extended to operators. A May 2026 agreement gives Moov Africa secure access to the national identification number database, and the World Bank project relies on international contractors with an emphasis on knowledge transfer so that local teams can maintain what they introduce. Whether the state holds the source code and operating skills for the SIGPTS identity platform, or can exit its contract with Idemia, was not on record as at September 2026. The terms on which the Huawei contract for the national data centre and ANATS's agreements with Airtel and Moov Africa govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

The government frames its AI aims as sovereign. At the first UN global dialogue on AI governance in July 2026 the minister set out a vision of AI developed, deployed and used in an ethical, frugal and sovereign way. On the continental layer, Chad's self-assessment on the African Union's AUDP-CAT tool put its data governance maturity at 30.27%, and the government is drafting a National Data Governance Strategy with ECA and GIZ under the AU Data Policy Framework (May 2026).

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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